Outlook

Re: RHD modelling

From Neema Minja <nminja@uw.edu>
Date Thu 10/8/2026 6:35 AM
To David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

Great, thank you. I have started the slides to share for the expert meeting.
Noted on scheduling- most likely the meeting will be the week of 19th. Andrea has shared her availability. Am waiting for the others.

Interestingly, I do not have details on when the poster is due (just have email details on format/printing etc.) It will be a physical poster. I could not find submission details on the congress website either. I have written an email to inquire.

Best,
Neema

From: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Sent: 07 October 2026 19:18
To: Neema Minja <nminja@uw.edu>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: RHD modelling

8am Seattle won't work next week (14th), but it will work the following week on Tue-Fri.

William and I met today, and he will work on a model update early next week so you can start prepping slides for the expert meeting.

I think the slides (tables and figures) will be the foundation of your poster.

When is the poster due? And is it digital or print?

From: Neema Minja <nminja@uw.edu>
Date: Tuesday, October 6, 2026 at 6:33 AM
To: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: RHD modelling

This is a good start thanks.

Just going to send that email soon, I want to present some time suggestions too - which times work for you? The usual 8am PT Thursday is one option for both weeks, any others for next and the week after.

Thanks.

From: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Sent: 05 October 2026 19:19

To: Neema Minja <nminja@uw.edu>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: RHD modelling

I think start with these slides

1. Overview of study objectives
2. Model design/schematic
3. Table of data inputs (including provisional parameters like TPs)
4. Description of analysis plan/scenarios
5. Preliminary results (abstract, updated)
6. Questions for experts (maybe 1-2 slides, include again the figure on literature progression rates etc)

DW

From: Neema Minja <nminja@uw.edu>
Date: Monday, October 5, 2026 at 7:11 PM
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: RHD modelling

Sounds good - thanks, David and William.

William - if you have a template/previous slide deck, it would be helpful to have a look and build for this RHD work in a similar manner and share by Thursday.

Best,
Neema

From: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Sent: 05 October 2026 17:02
To: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Neema Minja <nminja@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: RHD modelling

Hi Neema and David,

Great! I'm glad I can help. Let's chat on Wednesday.

Best,

William

From: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Sent: Monday, October 5, 2026 4:36 PM
To: Neema Minja <nminja@uw.edu>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: RHD modelling

Thanks, Neema,

Let me work with William this week to make some tweaks to the current model based on what you shared in the attached file.

We can then have a call with experts in the next 1-2 weeks to get their feedback on the remaining questions re: TPs for progression, surgery effect, etc.

I think it's more productive to structure this discussion with experts by creating a short slide deck explaining the rationale, model structure, parameters, and preliminary results. 5-10 slides max. The slide deck would end with some questions for experts that can be discussed on the call. You can circulate the slide deck before the meeting.

William has done similar slide decks for other projects, so he can help you put this together. **Neema**, I suggest going ahead now and trying to set up a meeting with Andrea & co (including the folks who couldn't join the last meeting) and let them know you want to do this by 3rd week of Oct to finalize your results and poster for Perth. We can try to have a slide deck ready to send to them by the end of this week, assuming the meeting would be the week of the 12th or 19th.

William, have a look at what Neema did below/attached, and let's chat Wednesday afternoon about how to implement (if you have any questions). I don't think it will take too long on your end.

DW

From: Neema Minja <nminja@uw.edu>
Date: Friday, October 2, 2026 at 1:54 PM
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Cc: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: RHD modelling

Hi William,

Thanks for joining us yesterday. I promised to send some more work on uncertainties we had in parameters.
For RHD specific mortality: According to the main route/plausible mechanism, RHD specific deaths should occur in stage D (RHD with complications). Right now, we have deaths possible from stage A to D - a suggestion would be to absorb those into stage D (RHD with complications). For a starting point, attaching a table with some background calculations using GBD data and literature sources. Column K is based on GBD data on RHD HF proportion as a proxy for stage D and using that to estimate TP for stage D to death. Column J is the same calculation using data from literature to estimate stage D. Here the TP is much lower because the discrepancy with literature producing a larger denominator for total proportion in stage D and GBD a smaller proportion for deaths. Can we use figures from column K and replace the current parameters and re-run the model that I can share with experts for further discussion next week?

David - the table here also has the scenarios split into 0 - 39 and 40+ years, showing mortality is disproportionately high in 40+ in Uganda (2 vs 73%, still very much an overkill).

The other thing William is I plan to get clarification on how surgery works to impact the pathway: i.e. conceptually, post-surgery, would someone go to an earlier stage e.g. from D - C etc. or more preventing D to death just to double check. I will also have to confirm if surgery applies to both C and D (currently we have it that way as I thought some in C need surgery before complications based on echo measurements and symptoms etc.). We don't need to do anything about these for now.

Was there another issue/uncertainty to bring up with experts? (apart from finalizing each stage transition as well?- I have an updated table with literature data)

Thank you,
Neema

From: Neema Minja
Sent: 18 September 2026 14:39
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Cc: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Subject: RHD modelling

Hi William,

Hope you are well! Good news - our abstract submission was accepted to the World Congress of RHD conference in November 🙂 My thanks to you and David for the collaborative work!

We have been linked to two colleagues from UK doing modelling work on RHD vaccines and it's a chance to share ideas as we are doing parallel work- we are setting up a meeting for the 1st of Oct at 8am PT. Let me know if that works for you and I will send out the invite.

On another note, I am hoping to close in on uncertainties we had around the parameters. I chatted to David about what we need to reach out to RHD experts on the parameterization, and he suggested we make a few modifications to the parameters in the current model. I am figuring things out and will send an email next week.

Best,
Neema.